> declare their cells a terrorist organization and to impose on them the same anti-terrorist laws and regulations that are used against Palestinian terrorists.
>
> Now, with the murder of the Palestinian boy, we may embark on the most dangerous stage, which is the nightmarish scenario of the Shin Bet. This may be the era in which local gangs, incited by politicians or poisoned by anti-Arab sentiments and atmosphere, turn into vigilantes and take the law into their own hands.[20]

Indeed, the incitement and racism would soon grow worse, becoming a regular fixture of political discourse. The following summer, the "vigilantes" would commit a crime that rivaled the Abu Khdair murder in its brutality.

The "martyr of the dawn"

Mourners tucked into plates of rice and lamb as the sun set over their colorful funeral tent, adorned with photos of the young-looking Abu Khdair —who they called "the martyr of the dawn". The tent was watched from both ends of the street by black-clad members of the *magav*, the paramilitary border police, clutching tear gas launchers and automatic rifles. Broken glass and chunks of concrete littered the street; charred dumpsters rendered it impassible, forcing the few cars passing through to use the railroad tracks.

Not that it mattered, since the light rail had been out of service for days. "Price tag: Death to Israel, death to Jews," someone had spray-painted in Hebrew on the trashed station nearby.

"Don't cause too much trouble. This week has been difficult," an elderly woman warned a group of young men as she shuffled home. Several of them ignored her advice: They climbed to the roof of a nearby building, shooting fireworks over the heads of the officers and sending everyone running for cover.

In quieter times the Shuafat neighborhood is a middle-class redoubt, full of villas populated by East Jerusalem's professional class. Many of the mourners at Abu Khdair's funeral tent were doctors, nurses, lawyers; some were Palestinians from the US and Europe, visiting family for the summer.

Yet that July was not a quiet time. The riots started on the morning of 2 July, shortly after police found Abu Khdair's body in the forest. It was so badly charred that it would take more than twenty-four hours to make an official identification, but the neighborhood knew Abu Khdair had been